



Code of Conduct

Higher Time-Derivative Theories Seminar

This online seminar series brings together researchers who may hold different views and approaches. To ensure a respectful and productive exchange, we have adopted the following code of conduct, based on standards commonly used at virtual scientific meetings. Most points will be familiar, but stating them explicitly provides a common framework for a smooth and fair seminar.

Rules for all participants

Please note: This code of conduct applies to the seminar as a whole: the presentation, written comments in the chat, the discussion after the talk, and informal interaction before and after the meeting. During the presentation, the speaker will not be interrupted; spoken questions and comments are reserved for the discussion afterwards.

- Please keep yourself on "mute" during the presentation to reduce background noise.
- The presentation will not be interrupted by spoken questions or comments. Questions and comments may be posted in the chat during the talk; the same standards of courtesy and relevance apply there as in the spoken discussion.
- After the presentation there will be a moderated discussion. To ask a question or make a comment, please use the "raise hand" button and wait for the chair to invite you to speak.
- When speaking during the discussion:
 - No personal attacks (ad hominem) will be allowed. If you disagree, address the argument, not the person.
 - In a debate, avoid using fallacies. For common examples see for instance [here](#).
 - No offensive or derogatory language, or shouting, will be tolerated.
 - If you disagree with someone's viewpoint, please state the reasons as clearly as possible.
 - Do not take up all the talking time; allow other participants to speak. Keep your comments and questions concise.
 - When asking a question to the speaker or other participants, give them ample time to respond.
 - Stick to the subject of the talk and avoid unnecessary digressions.
 - Respect the speaker and do not use their time or that of others simply to advertise your own work.
 - Do not interrupt or talk over someone else during the discussion, or use body language to distract or disrupt others.
- The speaker and all participants should feel safe to bring up contentious issues. They should not be made uncomfortable by other participants.
- No demeaning, discriminatory, or harassing behaviour or speech focused on protected characteristics (culture, age, ethnicity, gender, sexuality, disability, religion, marriage or civil partnership status, gender reassignment), or on hierarchical status, will be tolerated.

- Harassment includes: offensive verbal comments related to gender, sexual orientation, race, religion, or disability; inappropriate use of nudity and/or sexual images in public spaces (including presentation slides); deliberate intimidation, stalking or following; harassing photography or recording; sustained disruption of talks or other events; and unwelcome sexual attention.
- Be considerate, courteous and respectful at all times.
- Be mindful of cultural differences. What may be acceptable in one culture may be offensive in another. This is important as we have participants from across the globe.
- Be mindful of your surroundings and of your fellow attendees. Alert the seminar organisers if you notice a dangerous situation or someone in distress.
- If you are subjected to unacceptable behaviour, notice that someone else is being subjected to unacceptable behaviour, or have any other concerns during the event, please notify a member of the organising committee as soon as possible. All reports will remain completely confidential.
- If evidence is provided that a participant has engaged in unacceptable behaviour, the seminar organisers may take any action they deem appropriate, up to and including expulsion from the seminar series.
- Should you wish to discuss any issue outside the actual online meeting, please contact the organisers by e-mail or other means. All reports will remain completely confidential.

Rules for chairs and moderators

- Chairs and moderators will not allow personal bias or knowledge to influence their decisions. Please be mindful of possible unconscious biases as well. Details on unconscious bias can be found, for instance, [here](#) or [here](#).
- Keep your interventions short and precise. Please ensure that the discussion keeps moving and that all participants have an equal chance to express their views.
- Be firm and decisive when necessary, but please be respectful to all.
- If necessary, be flexible enough to maximise the quality of the discussion. Depending on the context, it is appropriate to bring in a personal question, involve the audience, or give the speaker more or less time.